

STORYBOARD

Tailboard Talk 2.0: Job Briefings for a Modernizing Grid

Prepared by Jordan Smith | Companion to the Needs Analysis—see that document for objectives, audience, and rationale | September 2026

Course Structure Overview

Lesson	Purpose	Est. runtime
1. Why the Tailboard Talk Is Changing	Establish the strategic/regulatory context and the two new hazard categories	~3–4 min
2. Running an Updated Briefing	Video framing → branching scenario practice → knowledge check → job aid	~7–8 min

Lesson 1—Why the Tailboard Talk Is Changing

#	Rise block type	On-screen content	Notes
1.1	Lesson header (auto)	Lesson 1: Why the Tailboard Talk Is Changing	Default Rise cover
1.2	Statement	“Every job starts the same way: a tailboard talk. Hazards. Protective measures. Roles. But the grid you’re briefing for today isn’t the grid you trained on.”	Full-bleed statement block; sets the hook
1.3	Text	“Utilities across North America—including right here in Ottawa—are investing heavily in smart-grid technology: remote-controlled switches, automated fault detection, and automatic restoration. At the same time, more customers are generating their own power, from rooftop solar to battery storage, and feeding it back onto the grid. Both trends are good news for reliability and sustainability. They also introduce a hazard your tailboard talk needs to catch.”	Plain paragraph block
1.4	Labeled graphic (2 markers)	Marker 1: “Could this circuit be re-energized automatically, without a person initiating it?” (automated switching / reclosers) · Marker 2: “Could this circuit be backfed by a source other than the system operator?” (distributed energy resources)	Use a simple utility-pole/substation stock image as the base graphic
1.5	Quote	“Ambiguity is what turns a routine job into a fatality. The clearance you requested is only as good as the questions you asked to get it.”	Reinforces stakes before moving on
1.6	Continue	Continue to Lesson 2	Standard Rise continue button

Lesson 2—Running an Updated Briefing

#	Rise block type	On-screen content	Notes
2.1	Text	Recap: a standard tailboard talk covers hazards, protective measures, and roles. This lesson adds a fourth checkpoint—see it in action below.	Short orientation paragraph
2.2	Video	Jordan’s recorded intro (see Video Script below)	Embed via URL (unlisted)

			YouTube/Vimeo), not direct upload
2.3	Scenario	Branching tailboard-talk simulation (see Scenario Script below)	Rise Scenario block—dialogue content, up to 3 responses per turn
2.4	Knowledge check	1–2 questions (see Knowledge Check below)	Multiple choice / true-false
2.5	Button	“Download the Tailboard Talk 2.0 job aid”	Link to the hosted PDF
2.6	Statement	“The infrastructure is changing faster than habits do. One more question in the briefing is a small cost for closing that gap.”	Closing line

Video Script—Block 2.2 (~60–90 seconds)

“Hi, I’m Jordan, and I’ll be walking you through today’s briefing. Here’s the situation: your crew’s been dispatched to a routine line repair on a residential feeder. Nothing about the work order looks unusual. But before anyone touches that line, you need to run the briefing—and this feeder has two things worth flagging: it’s on a circuit with a new automated recloser installed last month, and there are now four homes on this block with rooftop solar. Neither of those facts is on the work order. Finding them is your job, and it starts with the questions you ask in this tailboard talk. Ready? Let’s run it.”

Production notes:

- Landscape orientation, plain or blurred background, good front lighting—a simple webcam take is fine.
- One continuous take at a natural pace; a script this short doesn’t need to be memorized word-for-word, close paraphrase is fine as long as the two flagged facts (recloser, four solar homes) land clearly.
- Keep it under 90 seconds—this is the framing beat, not the lesson itself.

Scenario Script—Block 2.3

Rise 360’s Scenario block structures content as scenes made of dialogue turns; each turn offers up to three responses, each with its own feedback and “Go to” destination. Structure below.

Scene	Character line	Learner response option	Feedback	Go to
A— Opening	Crew Lead: “Okay team, quick job—replace a cracked insulator on Feeder 12B. Should take twenty minutes. Let’s do the tailboard and get moving.”	R1 (best): “Before we do—has dispatch confirmed this segment’s been isolated and tagged by the system operator, and is there anything on this feeder we should know about, like automated switching or customer-owned generation nearby?”	“Good catch. Confirming clearance AND asking about modernization-specific hazards up front is exactly right.”	Scene B
A— Opening	(same)	R2 (incomplete): “Sure, let’s just confirm the clearance tag number and get started.”	“That’s a good habit, but it’s not enough anymore—the tag confirms manual isolation, not whether something else could re-energize this line. Try again.”	Retry Scene A

A— Opening	(same)	R3 (weak): “Twenty minutes, easy—let’s just get started, we can ask questions if something looks off.”	“This is exactly the kind of ambiguity that leads to serious incidents. Let’s look at what could go wrong.”	Scene C
B— Follow-up	Crew Lead: “Good question—yes, Feeder 12B got a new automated recloser installed last month as part of the smart-grid rollout, and there are three solar installations on this block.”	R1 (best): “Then we need the system operator to confirm the recloser is in manual lockout, not just open, and confirm those solar installations are disconnected before we proceed.”	“Exactly. A lockout, not just an open position—and DER disconnects verified, not assumed.”	Scene D (success ending)
B— Follow-up	(same)	R2 (incomplete): “As long as the tag’s up, we’re fine.”	“Not quite—a tag on a manual switch doesn’t address the recloser or the solar systems. Think about what else could put voltage back on this line.”	Retry Scene B
C—Near miss	Narration (text card, no character): “Fifteen minutes into the job, the automated recloser attempts a reclose cycle. The line the crew is working on briefly carries voltage. No one is hurt this time—but only because of timing.”	Continue	—	Back to Scene A
D— Success ending	Crew Lead: “Confirmed—system operator’s got the recloser in manual lockout, and all three solar disconnects are verified open. We’re clear to proceed.”	Continue	—	End Scenario → Block 2.4

Knowledge Check—Block 2.4

Q1 (multiple choice): “Which of the following is a NEW hazard category that grid modernization adds to a standard tailboard talk?”

- A) Weather conditions
- B) Automated/remote re-energization and distributed energy resource backfeed—CORRECT
- C) PPE availability
- D) Traffic control

Correct feedback: “Right—modernization adds sources of energization beyond the system operator, which is exactly what the updated briefing question is designed to catch.”

Q2 (true/false): “A clearance tag on a manually operated switch is enough to confirm a modernized circuit can’t be re-energized.”

Answer: False. Feedback: “A tag confirms manual isolation only—it doesn’t address an automated recloser or a customer’s solar system backfeeding the line. That’s exactly why Tailboard Talk 2.0 adds a dedicated question.”

Job Aid Content Outline—Block 2.5

Delivered as a separate one-page PDF (Jordan Smith - Job Aid - Tailboard Talk 2.pdf). Content:

- Title: “Tailboard Talk 2.0” with the “Ambiguity = Fatality” line carried over from standard practice.
- Steps 1–4: the unchanged core (clearance/isolation, hazards, protective measures, roles), as brief prompts.
- Step 5, visually flagged as NEW: two checkbox questions covering automated/remote switching and DER backfeed, each with the specific confirmation required (manual lockout; verified disconnect).
- Footer: general reference to OSHA and ILSA safe-practice guidelines; designer credit.